ILLINOIS

Spring 2026

PS 280 TD3, Discussion - Intro to Intl Relations (Jaeyoung Lee)

Created **Saturday, May 30, 2026**

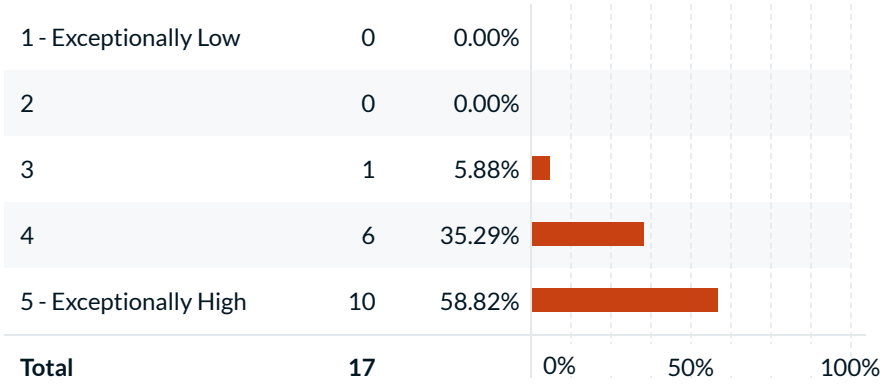
Survey Audience: **29**
Responses Received: **17**
Response Ratio: **58.62 %**

This course is considered to have a class size "Medium", a course type of "Mixed", and an instructor type of "TA".

	Elective	%	Required but a Choice	%	Specifically Required	%	Total Responses	%	Mean
What requirement did this course fulfill for your degree?	2	11.76%	10	58.82%	5	29.41%	17	58.62%	2.18
Which option best describes why you're taking this course?	0	N/A	0	N/A	0	N/A	0	0.00%	NRP

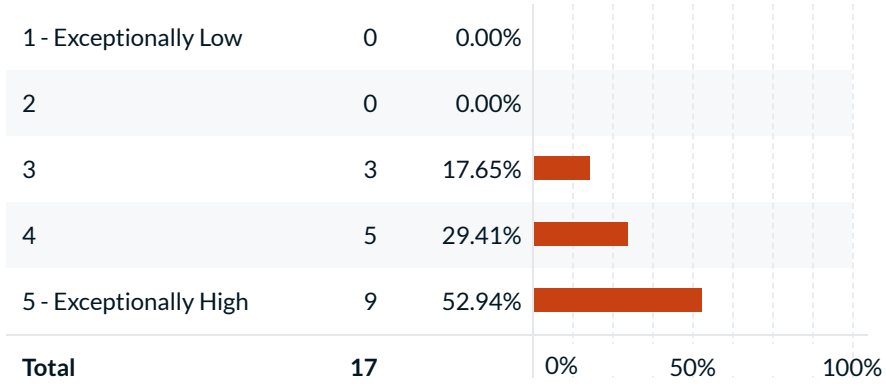
Global Items

1. Rate the instructor's overall teaching effectiveness.



Statistics	Value
Invited Count	29
Response Count	17
Response Ratio	58.62%
Mean	4.53
Standard Deviation	0.62

2. Rate the overall quality of this course.

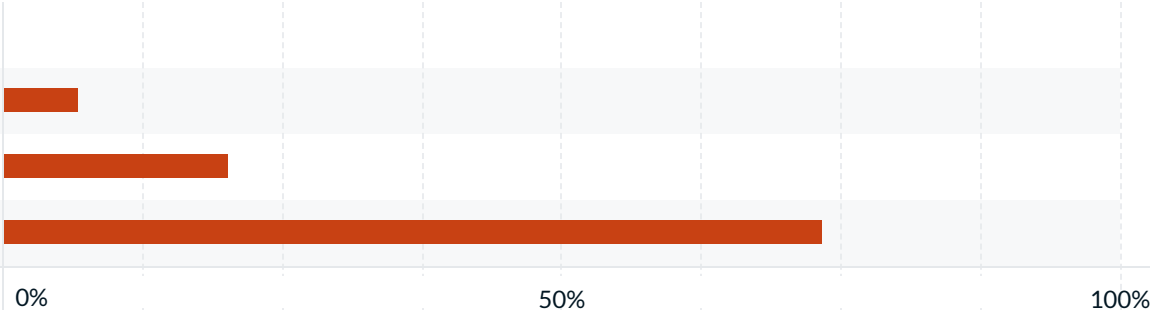


Statistics	Value
Invited Count	29
Response Count	17
Response Ratio	58.62%
Mean	4.35
Standard Deviation	0.79

Course Design

The instructor clearly described learning objectives for the course.

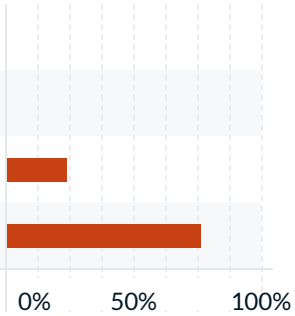
1 Slightly clearly or not at all clearly	0	0.00%
2 Somewhat clearly	1	6.67%
3 Mostly clearly	3	20.00%
4 Very clearly	11	73.33%
Total	**15**	



Statistics	Value
Invited Count	29
Response Count	15
Response Ratio	51.72%
Mean	3.67
Standard Deviation	0.62

1. The activities and materials provided to support my learning were closely aligned with the graded assignments/assessments of learning.

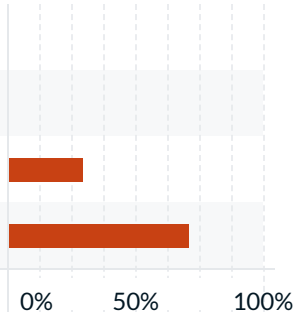
1 Slightly true or not at all true	0	0.00%
2 Somewhat true	0	0.00%
3 Mostly true	4	23.53%
4 Very true	13	76.47%
Total	**17**	



Statistics	Value
Invited Count	29
Response Count	17
Response Ratio	58.62%
Mean	3.76
Standard Deviation	0.44

2. Based on the course description, I gained the knowledge/skills that I expected to gain from participating in this course.

1 Slightly true or not at all true	0	0.00%
2 Somewhat true	0	0.00%
3 Mostly true	5	29.41%
4 Very true	12	70.59%
Total	**17**	

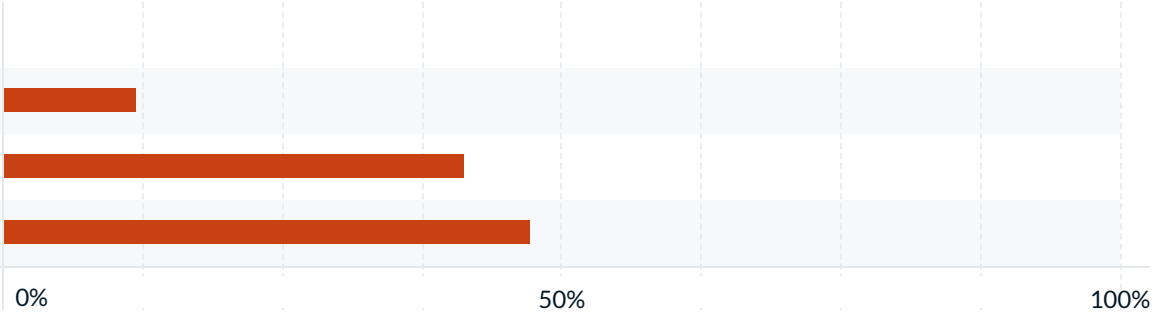


Statistics	Value
Invited Count	29
Response Count	17
Response Ratio	58.62%
Mean	3.71
Standard Deviation	0.47

Course Delivery

I received useful feedback on my performance in this course.

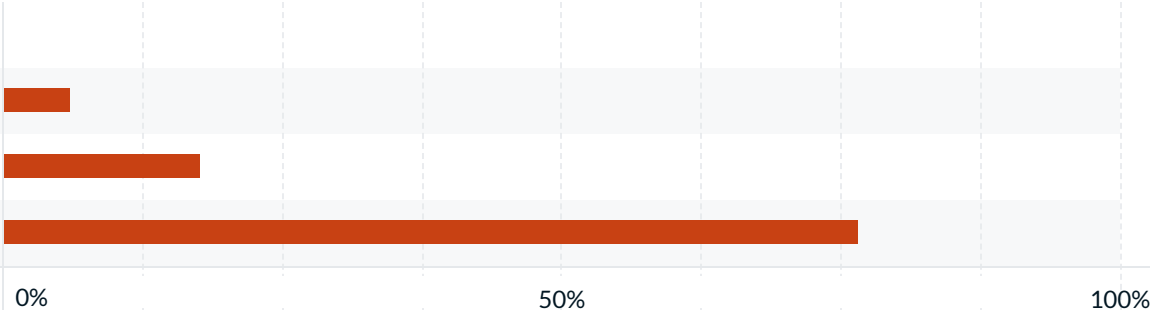
1 Slightly useful or not at all useful	0	0.00%
2 Somewhat useful	2	11.76%
3 Mostly useful	7	41.18%
4 Very useful	8	47.06%
Total	**17**	



Statistics	Value
Invited Count	29
Response Count	17
Response Ratio	58.62%
Mean	3.35
Standard Deviation	0.70

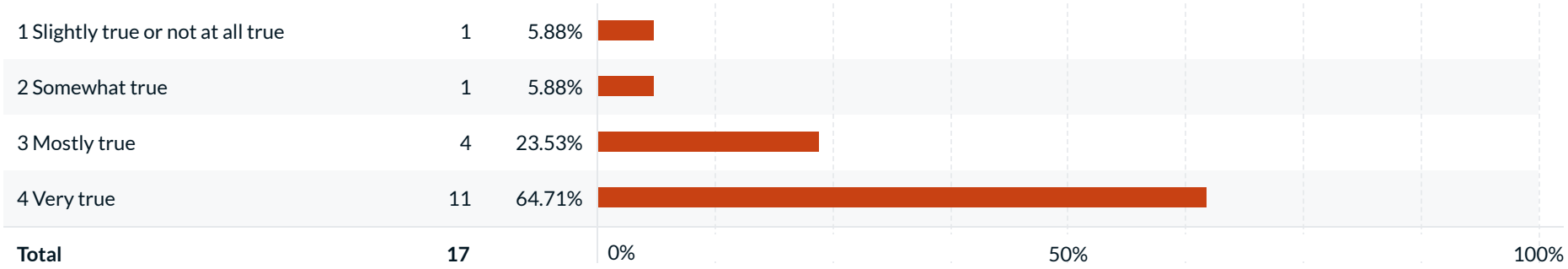
1. I felt that there was sufficient instructor support to achieve the course learning goals.

1 Slightly true or not at all true	0	0.00%
2 Somewhat true	1	5.88%
3 Mostly true	3	17.65%
4 Very true	13	76.47%
Total	**17**	



Statistics	Value
Invited Count	29
Response Count	17
Response Ratio	58.62%
Mean	3.71
Standard Deviation	0.59

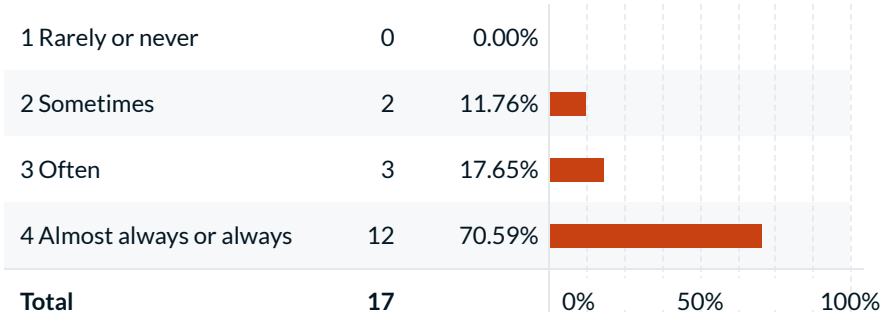
2. There were plenty of opportunities (i.e., activities, assignments, projects) to practice and apply the knowledge/skills learned in this course.



Statistics	Value
Invited Count	29
Response Count	17
Response Ratio	58.62%
Mean	3.47
Standard Deviation	0.87

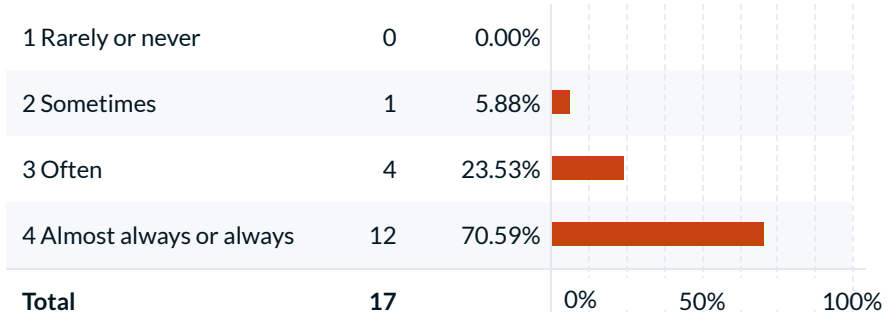
Inclusive and Ethical Practices

1. Assignments were graded in alignment with rubrics/assignment descriptions.



Statistics	Value
Invited Count	29
Response Count	17
Response Ratio	58.62%
Mean	3.59
Standard Deviation	0.71

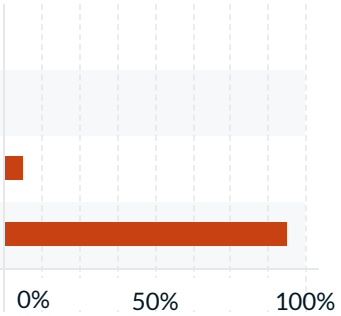
2. I knew where to look for course materials when I needed them.



Statistics	Value
Invited Count	29
Response Count	17
Response Ratio	58.62%
Mean	3.65
Standard Deviation	0.61

3. The instructor facilitated a welcoming classroom environment.

1 Rarely or never	0	0.00%
2 Sometimes	0	0.00%
3 Often	1	5.88%
4 Almost always or always	16	94.12%
Total	**17**	

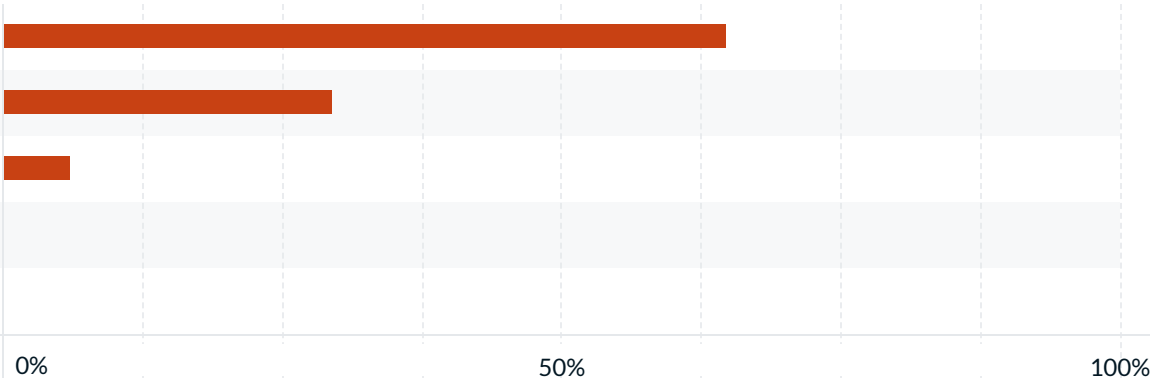


Statistics	Value
Invited Count	29
Response Count	17
Response Ratio	58.62%
Mean	3.94
Standard Deviation	0.24

Course Engagement

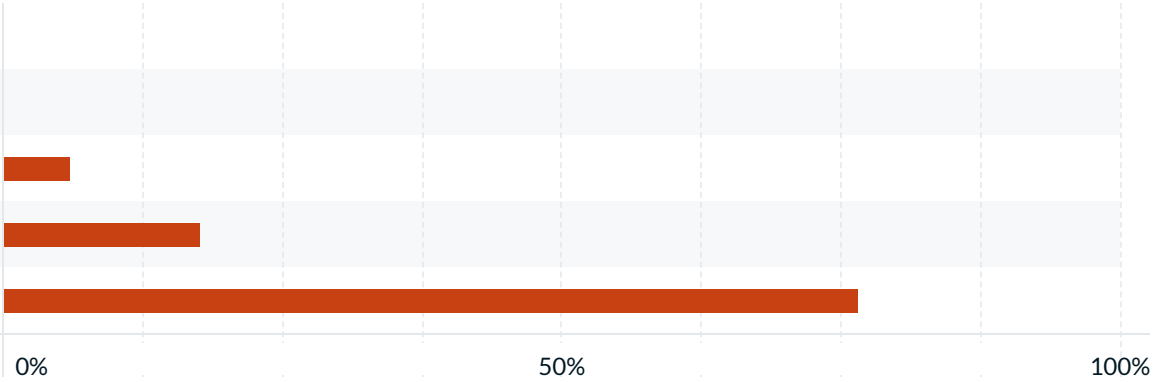
Adding together both time spent in class and time spent out of class, what was the average number of hours per week you spent on this course?

1 <5	11	64.71%
2 6-10	5	29.41%
3 11-15	1	5.88%
4 16-20	0	0.00%
5 21+	0	0.00%
Total	**17**	



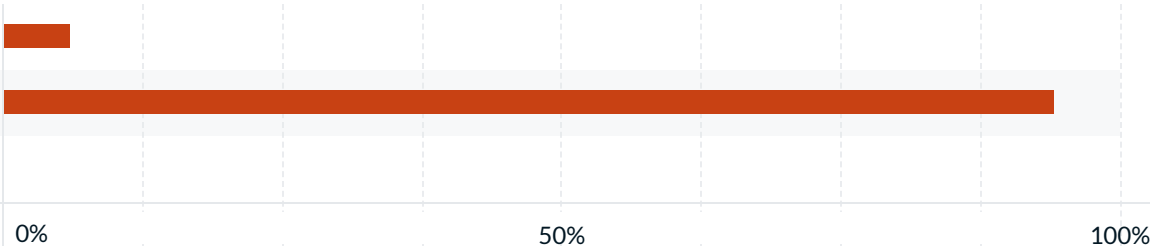
What percentage of classes or class recordings did you attend or view?

<20%	0	0.00%
20-40%	0	0.00%
41-60%	1	5.88%
61-80%	3	17.65%
80%+	13	76.47%
Total	**17**	



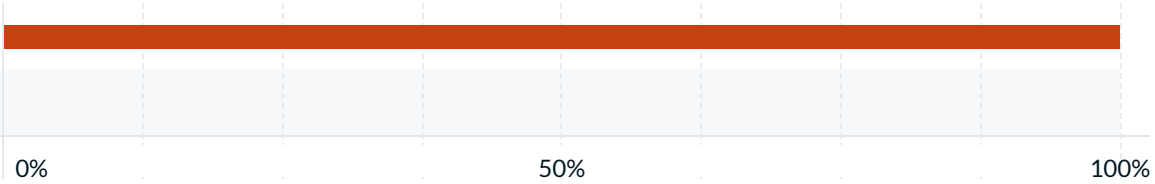
Did you take this course to fulfill a general education requirement?

Yes	1	5.88%
No	16	94.12%
Unsure	0	0.00%
Total	**17**	



Are you a degree-seeking student?

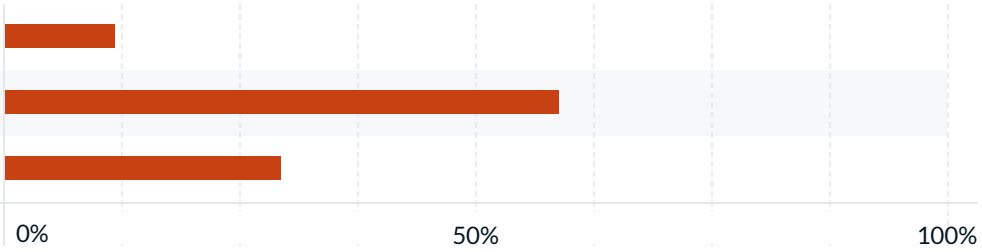
Yes	17	100.00%
No	0	0.00%
Total	**17**	



Shown to Degree-seeking Students

What requirement did this course fulfill for your degree?

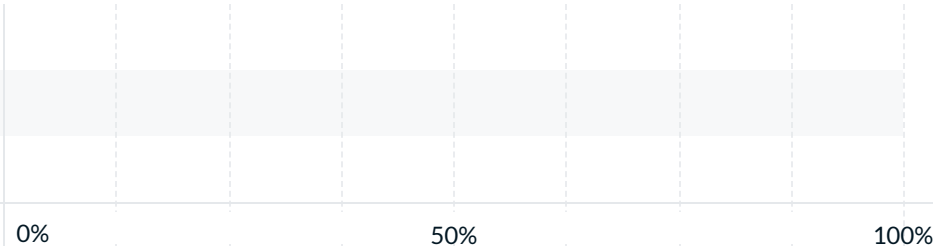
Elective	2	11.76%
Required but a choice in major, intended major, or minor	10	58.82%
Specifically required by major, intended major, or minor	5	29.41%
Total	**17**	



Shown to Non-degree-seeking Students

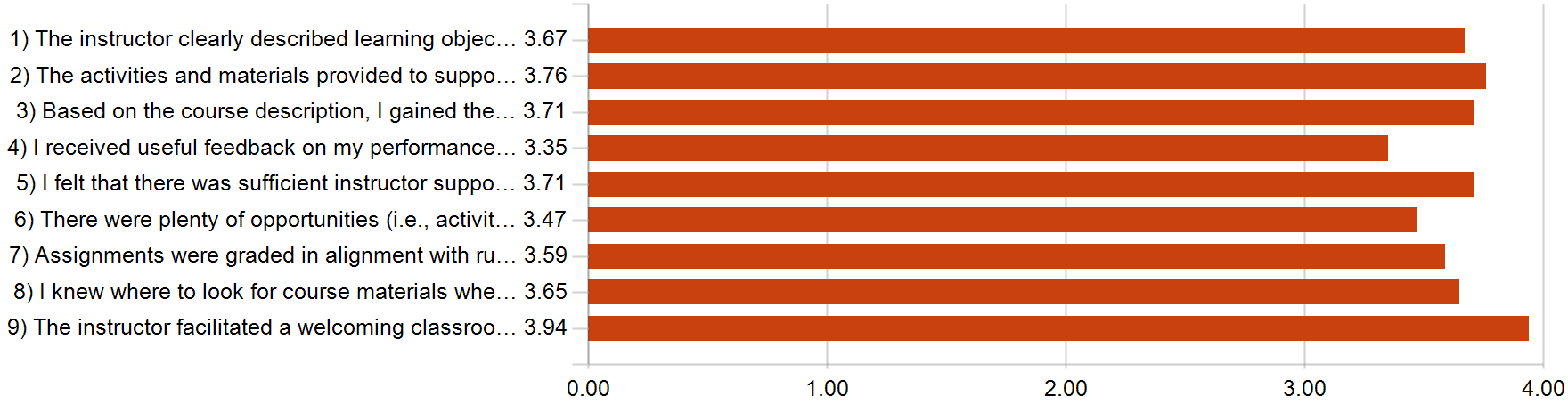
Which option best describes why you're taking this course?

Elective	0	0.00%
To fulfill a requirement but a choice amongst several courses	0	0.00%
To fulfill a specific requirement	0	0.00%
Total	**0**	



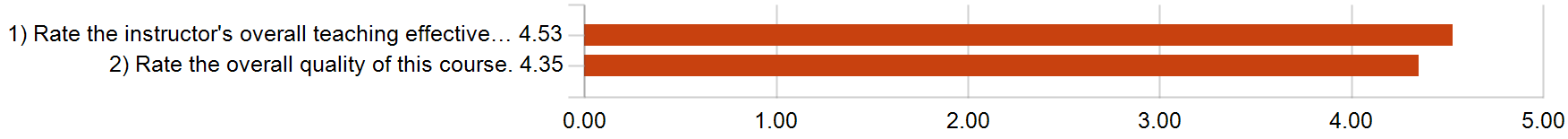
Rating Scale Item Means

Rating Scale Item Means (4 selections)



Question	Mean
The instructor clearly described learning objectives for the course.	3.67
The activities and materials provided to support my learning were closely aligned with the graded assignments/assessments of learning.	3.76
Based on the course description, I gained the knowledge/skills that I expected to gain from participating in this course.	3.71
I received useful feedback on my performance in this course.	3.35
I felt that there was sufficient instructor support to achieve the course learning goals.	3.71
There were plenty of opportunities (i.e., activities, assignments, projects) to practice and apply the knowledge/skills learned in this course.	3.47
Assignments were graded in alignment with rubrics/assignment descriptions.	3.59
I knew where to look for course materials when I needed them.	3.65
The instructor facilitated a welcoming classroom environment.	3.94

Rating Scale Item Means (5 selections)



Question	Mean
Rate the instructor's overall teaching effectiveness.	4.53
Rate the overall quality of this course.	4.35

FLEX Open-Ended Items

What aspects of the course design and/or delivery most benefitted your learning?

Comments
For this class, I liked the activities we did in class to review the material from the week, as they helped reinforce key concepts.
I really liked how open to discussion the section was and how we talked and discussed about the lectures given in class that week and broke them down.
Jaeyoung did an excellent job creating a variety of activities to recap the content we had learned through lectures. She meshed lecture–style reviews of required readings with more hands–on group activities wonderfully. NOTE: this is for Jaeyoung's PS 280 Discussion Section TD5, on Fridays from 1:00–1:50 PM.
I like that the discussion involved a review of what we learned that week.
I enjoyed the collaborative classroom environment that was built. I like how we used games like Jeopardy or team games in order to help us learn more about the information we were being told in lecture. I found these sections as a really good review for the topics and lessons we discussed in lectures during the week.
I really appreciated how she would go over key points in the readings and lectures because in lecture, it was oftentimes hard to tell what terms were worth studying.
Jaeyoung has been a wonderful guide for the course, especially because the breadth of readings assigned and the content of the lectures can be a little disparate at times. It is very clear, through the way she has structured discussions, that she has put time and thought into what key takeaways we should glean from that week. Her focus is always on our success, and our discussions are consistently enjoyable.
Reading/Lecture reviews
The activities in class were helpful because they applied the topics we learned, and she helped review the reading materials for each week.
I think that the group work/simulations most benefitted my learning because it gave me the chance to practice what I was taught.
...
Summary of lectures and readings helped a lot.
The engagement in the discussions
Our TA was really helpful in discussion and went over just about everything we needed to know before the tests
The discussion style, very engaging, played useful games

What change to the course design or delivery would most benefit your learning?

Comments
At times, working in small groups was not very helpful because participation was uneven, and some students did not contribute. This made the activities less effective for learning.
Have a bit more opportunities to have group work.
I think if I had access to the lecture–style slides after the discussion section, this would make my absorption of content easier. Sometimes I felt like I could not keep up with the pace of the lecturer. NOTE: this is for Jaeyoung's PS 280 Discussion Section TD5, on Fridays from 1:00–1:50 PM.
I wish we could have access to the slides my TA posted so that we could study more efficiently as I felt the slides from lectures were not sufficient enough in information
I really wouldn't recommend changing anything because I thought that the way that the class was split up was very effective in making sure we were learning efficiently within the 50 minutes that we have.
None, I honestly gained more out of the discussion section than the lecture, got really good feedback on my essay, and I looked foward to going every Friday.
I appreciate the discussions for their current structure.
It would have helped to have a copy of the slides because she went too fast sometimes.
I don't think there are any changes I would make. I think the class functioned well and I was able to walk away with a better understanding of the material.
debate topics in discussion section would be entertaining and engaging.
Honestly no change, prefer the discussion over the lecture.
More assignments to allow us to benchmark our understanding of the topics.
nothing
Nothing

What recommendations would you give to future students of this course?

Comments
I would say that students taking this course should attend discussion sections every week to stay on track with the material.
Pay attention in lecture because it most likely WILL be on the test/essay.
Take advantage of discussion sections to take away key concepts from weekly lectures. NOTE: this is for Jaeyoung's PS 280 Discussion Section TD5, on Fridays from 1:00–1:50 PM.
I would recommend to future students that they pay attention in lecture and attend them so that you can get the most out of the discussion sections. I enjoyed coming to discussion and thought I learned a lot from this class.
Go to discussion, it is really fun and it helps you gain a lot more clarity on what is going on in the course!
Read, engage, and take notes!
Participate in the discussions and try to pay attention in lecture, or you will be lost in discussion.
I would recommend listening more than note taking in discussion. Because the main slides are posted by Professor Grossman, I found it helpful to just listen and participate in discussion rather than try to take notes simultaneously.
attend lecture and do class readings.
Try your best to understand different theories apply to different situations.
Do the readings and test your own knowledge, because the course does not provide that
make sure to come to class, it really helps
Come to discussion, it's the best part if you have Ms. Lee